

Thomas Lazarowicz

Department of Economics
University College London
Drayton House, 30 Gordon Street
London WC1H 0AX, United Kingdom

thomas.lazarowicz.16@ucl.ac.uk
www.thomaslazarowicz.com
Citizenship: UK and Poland (EU)

Placement Director: Professor Attila Lindner
a.lindner@ucl.ac.uk

Placement Administrator: Daniella Harper
d.harper@ucl.ac.uk

Education

PhD in Economics, University College London	2020–2027 (expected)
Advisors: Vincent Sterk and Wei Cui	
MRes in Economics (<i>with Distinction</i>), University College London	2019–2020
MSc in Economics (<i>with Distinction</i>), University College London	2016–2017
MA in Economics (<i>First Class</i>), University of Edinburgh	2012–2016

Research Fields

Macroeconomics, Firm Dynamics, Monetary and Fiscal Policy.

Job Market Paper

Demand-Driven Stagnation: Customer Acquisition and Persistent Firm Growth Slowdowns

Peter Sinclair Prize for Best Paper, 13th MMF PhD Conference

Do the long-run costs of a fiscal consolidation depend on which households bear the cuts? I study the UK's 2010–2015 austerity programme, whose welfare cuts fell mostly on low-income households. Young firms in harder-hit local authorities cut customer acquisition by 15% relative to less-exposed peers, while their employment, capacity utilisation and markups were unaffected and mature firms show no comparable adjustment. Their output falls and stays depressed through 2014, well after the acquisition cut has faded, suggesting a durable loss of customer base. To explain why regressive shocks disproportionately scar young firms, I build a general equilibrium model in which firms accumulate customers from a heterogeneous-income population. Low-income customers churn faster, so young firms inherit poor-biased customer bases, and non-homothetic preferences make exactly these customers the most income-elastic. The result is a “churn trap”: young firms depend most on the households a regressive consolidation hits hardest. In the calibrated model, the actual 2010 incidence destroys 1.62 times more young, luxury-sector customer capital than a neutral consolidation of the same size, and the cohort entering during the shock never recovers its deficit. Without either differential churn or non-homotheticity, incidence ceases to matter for young firms. A progressive redesign raising the same revenue would have avoided roughly two-thirds of the damage: incidence matters as much as size.

Working Papers

Starting Over: The Cost of Fresh Starts and the Reallocation of Serial Entrepreneurs

Firms run by serial entrepreneurs are larger and more productive, yet how much their reallocation across businesses contributes to aggregate output is unknown. I develop a firm-dynamics model in which entrepreneurs learn about their own ability and their business-specific match quality, and must liquidate and refinance to start over. I estimate the model on administrative data covering the universe of UK firms linked to their beneficial owners, which lets me follow entrepreneurs across the businesses they run. Two facts discipline the mechanism: within entrepreneurs, the serial productivity premium predates the switch to a new business — selection on ability, not learning-by-doing — and exit rates rise and then fall with firm age, as they do in the model because entrepreneurs need time to learn whether a business is worth keeping. Lowering the cost of starting over raises aggregate output by 4 percent and triples the serial-entrepreneur share, with the gain coming from reallocating able entrepreneurs toward better matches rather than from entry or scale. For bankruptcy policy, the cost of starting over is what matters, not creditor recovery: raising recovery rates increases output only when it also makes fresh starts cheaper.

Monetary Transmission in a HANK Model with Housing and Rental Sectors,

with Daniel Albuquerque and Jamie Lenney

CFM Discussion Paper 2025-29

This paper develops a Heterogeneous Agent New Keynesian (HANK) model with housing and individual landlords to examine how monetary policy affects housing and rental markets. Using new UK evidence we document that contractionary monetary policy generates a large, hump-shaped, decline in house prices, while rental prices remain flat. We match the model to micro and macro data, showing that behavioural frictions combined with departures from a RANK framework are key for generating these price dynamics. The results reveal that landlords largely fail to pass through higher interest rates to rents. However, this incomplete pass-through reduces the output-inflation trade-off facing inflation-targeting central banks.

Household Debt and Labour Supply,

with Phil Bunn, Jagjit Chadha, Stephen Millard and Emma Rockall

Bank of England Staff Working Paper No. 941, 2021

In this paper, we first develop a theoretical framework with three types of household: outright homeowners, mortgagors and renters. We then examine empirically how household debt affects the response of labour supply to shocks to income, mortgage interest rates and house prices for each type of household. In line with our framework, we find that negative income shocks lead to lower participation among outright homeowners while increasing mortgagors' desired hours; surprise rises in interest rates lead to increases in desired hours that are larger the higher is the household's debt level; and falls in house prices increase mortgagors' desired hours.

Work in Progress

Winners and Losers from Monetary Policy: Evidence from the UK Rental Market,

with Morgane Richard

The Variance of Demand,

with Federico Pessina and Dajana Xhani

Industrial Policy and Firm Entry

Professional Experience

UCL MacroMonitor, PhD Analyst (nowcasting model development) 2025–present

Bank of England, PhD Intern, Monetary Policy Outlook Division, Modelling Unit 2024

University College London, Research Assistant to Wei Cui and Marta Morazzoni 2021–2024

Bank of England, Visiting Researcher (secondment) 2019

National Institute of Economic and Social Research, Macroeconomist 2017–2019

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, University College London

Advanced Macroeconomic Theory (MSc) 2025

Big Data Analytics (MSc) 2024–2025

Econometrics for Macroeconomics (Undergraduate) 2023–2024

Macroeconomic Theory and Policy (Undergraduate) 2020–2023

Time Series Econometrics (MSc) 2020–2022

Presentations (including scheduled)

2026: RES Annual Conference, EEA Annual Congress, HEC PhD Conference, MMF Annual Conference, MMF PhD Conference, QMUL PhD Workshop, UCL–Sciences Po Summer Workshop

2025: PSE Macro Days, UC3M, Stockholm, BoE–QMUL–Kent–Bristol Firm Dynamics Workshop, MMF Conference, MMF PhD Workshop, QMUL PhD Workshop

2024: Bank of England, ULB (ENTER Jamboree), Scottish Economic Society, Surrey Workshop in Macroeconomics

Awards and Scholarships

Peter Sinclair Prize for Best Paper, 13th MMF PhD Conference 2026

PhD Scholarship, UCL Stone Centre on Wealth Concentration, Inequality, and the Economy 2022–2023

UCL Studentship 2020–2025

Economics Education Award, Best TA on a second-year module 2022 & 2023

Professional Service

Mentor, Cambridge, LSE, Oxford, Warwick and UCL Applicant Mentoring Programme 2021–2025

Conference Organiser, UCL Stone Centre PhD Conference 2024

Skills

Computational: Python, Matlab, Stata, Git

Data access: ONS Secure Research Service Accredited Researcher

Languages: English (native)

References

Vincent Sterk

Professor of Economics
University College London
v.sterk@ucl.ac.uk

Morten Ravn

Professor of Economics
University College London
m.ravn@ucl.ac.uk

Wei Cui

Associate Professor
University College London
w.cui@ucl.ac.uk